Monitoring inclusive EMI implementation and outcomes

Practical guide for institutions | I08

Check whether planned EMI improvements are implemented, whether students can access teaching and support, and what changes in their learning experience. Use findings to guide practical action while maintaining disciplinary outcomes and standards.

Using this guide: Build this work into existing course evaluation, program review, quality assurance and academic governance cycles. This guide adds an EMI focus; it does not replace established review processes or introduce a separate institutional rating system.

1. Define the review question and intended change

Start with a specific barrier and the action intended to address it. State what successful implementation would look like and what improvement students should experience.

For example: after coordinating language support across a first-year program, do students understand where to seek help, reach suitable provision and receive support connected to course demands? Distinguish checking that a change happened from checking whether it helped.

2. Select a small set of useful evidence

Use evidence already available where suitable, supplemented only where it answers the review question. Consider the following different kinds of evidence:

- Implementation: revised materials, completed staff development trials or availability of agreed support.
- Access and experience: whether students can use resources, contribute to activities and reach support, including reasons for non-use.
- Learning: relevant student work, explanations or performance against stable disciplinary criteria. Use grade patterns as one indicator, not the sole measure of success.

3. Include ethnic-minority students' perspectives

Provide accessible and private ways to describe what helped, what remained difficult and what support was unavailable. Consult a range of students rather than expecting one person to speak for a community.

Where feasible, enable contributions in relevant ethnic-minority languages and arrange appropriate checks of meaning. Vietnamese may also help, but should not be assumed to be everyone's strongest language.

Use existing institutional rules for collecting and sharing student information. Gather only what is needed. Where group comparisons are justified, avoid reporting small groups in ways that identify individuals or imply that ethnicity explains a result.

4. Compare evidence and examine alternative explanations

Compare with an appropriate earlier task or period where possible, noting differences in students, content, task difficulty, marking or support access. Review examples of work and student accounts alongside numerical patterns.

A rise in grades does not by itself show that the intervention caused improvement. Equally, greater use of support may indicate better awareness and access rather than worsening need. Record uncertainty and investigate conflicting evidence.

5. Agree actions through the existing review cycle

Record what was implemented, what the evidence suggests, what remains uncertain and what should happen next. Name the action owner, resources and review point.

Continue or adapt useful practice, investigate persistent barriers and escalate unavailable provision through established governance or service processes. Tell students and staff what changed in response to their feedback, without disclosing personal information.

6. Check progress and maintain proportionate monitoring

Review agreed actions at the next suitable point in the course or program cycle. Check whether improvements remain accessible when staff, cohorts or resources change.

Remove evidence collection that is burdensome and unhelpful. Keep review focused on learning, participation and access, alongside standards, rather than simply counting resources, training attendance or referrals.

7. Example reviewing support across a first-year program

An existing program review examines recurring difficulties across several courses. The team combines student feedback, educators' observations, resource-access reports and support-service information. It finds inconsistent referral routes, inaccessible readings and limited provision for discipline-specific writing.

The program lead assigns actions to the relevant services and course teams, with resources and review dates. At the next review, the team checks access, successful referrals, student experience and relevant work against stable criteria. It records cohort and assessment differences, avoids attributing changes in grades to one action, and reports remaining provision gaps through existing governance.

8. Review checklist

☐ The review question and intended improvement are explicit.

☐ Implementation, access and learning are considered separately.

☐ Student perspectives include accessible routes for ethnic-minority students.

☐ Evidence collection and reporting follow institutional requirements.

☐ Alternative explanations and uncertainty are recorded.

☐ Actions have owners and feed into existing review and governance cycles.

9. When further institutional action is needed

Raise persistent barriers across courses, unmet language needs and unavailable support with the responsible program or institutional lead. Commission more detailed evaluation or specialist advice where routine review cannot answer a consequential question. This checklist does not establish that a program is effective or compliant.

10.Related toolkit guidance

I01: program design and review. I02–I04: needs and support pathways. I05: staff capability. I06: resources. I07: responsibility and referrals.

11.Supporting sources

Galloway, N. (Ed.). (2020). English in higher education – English medium. Part 1: Literature review. British Council. Open source

Section 10 (pp. 55–56) discusses holistic quality assurance and the limited empirical evaluation of EMI quality frameworks. This supports local evaluation, not treating this guide as a validated framework.

Galloway, N., & Sahan, K. (2021). An investigation into English Medium Instruction in higher education in Thailand and Vietnam. British Council. Open source

Section 9 calls for discipline- and context-sensitive investigation of support and implementation. Its recommendations inform the review focus; they do not validate the proposed indicators or establish causal effects.

The steps, example and checklist are toolkit adaptations for Vietnamese higher education. Sources support particular principles rather than the complete guide. The focus on ethnic-minority students and languages requires local consultation and evaluation. Developing draft for review; this is not a validated assessment or audit instrument.